

Q. How did Mitel manage this part of the world prior to the current agreement?

AK. Mitel is operating in more than 100 countries and has a global presence. But the Indian market was managed by our APAC (Asia Pacific) regional team, headquartered in Singapore. It also managed the ANZ, i.e., Australia, New Zealand and Singapore region along with managing the Indian operation. But after doing some internal realignment, we realized that we can utilize our Middle East resources, strength and experience in India. Some of the competitors are having a similar structure as well.

Since we wanted to serve the Indian market better, we moved our APAC team from there and connected them with the Middle East operation and here we are today!

Q. People are wondering why Mitel has become more aggressive than ever in recent times. What would you like to comment on this?

AK. We found some gaps in our strategy and we are trying to bridge them. That's making us look aggressive and that's fine. India is a very big region in terms of its potential and the addressable market, and it is continuously growing. We want to be a part of this journey. That's all we are at. That's why we are making these kinds of investments in the market. Put together Avientek and Mitel, we are going to have almost 10 people on the ground in India.

Q. What benefits do both of the companies seek out of this partnership?

AK. The benefits are threefold. The first benefit is growth. Mitel is growing in double digits YoY, and we need to replicate the same in the Indian market also. We want to go very aggressive.

Secondly, we are looking for customer acquisition in various segments. When revenue growth comes, it will definitely bring customers as well. For the last few years, Mitel has been going for verticalization of our strategy and we see vertical as our way forward—we want to get into hospitality, government, healthcare etc.

So, the trio of verticalization, customer acquisition and revenue is what we are looking at and distribution is going to play a very important role in getting this strategy in place.

Shrinivas Timmanagoudar. Avientek is one of the youngest and fast-growing distribution companies in India in recent times. We have distributions and AV partners across India. What we get on board with the Mitel partnership are the telecom partners. That's what we are looking at in the long term.

In India, we want a 360-degree approach. Today, we are an AV company and now we are going to telecom, so the next step would be IT. By forging partnerships like these, we're covering the whole industry with respect to what we provide. Tomorrow we can easily distribute any product across India as we will have a good reach. That'll take our revenue to higher levels and as per our revenue plan, we are hoping for an aggressive push to revenue, if not simply double the numbers for the next three to five years. At the same time, we are increasing our portfolio plus the geographical presence with new resources for each region.

And as Mitel has a legacy of around five decades, it is a stable company. So, even though we see a lot of rejig in the telecom industry, we increase our credibility in the market by aligning with a stable company.



Q. Which products and solutions are they going to distribute?

AK. Mitel has a complete portfolio addressing the horizontal as well as vertical needs of our customers. Horizontally speaking, we have a platform for very small-medium businesses to very large corporations and vertically, we have solutions fit for all purposes including hospitality, government and technology verticals like contact centres, banks and related segments. Avientek is going to distribute all our products and end-to-end solutions. In fact, we are going to add new products for the Indian market, such as some of the cloud offerings. Currently, we are evaluating all those propositions, from the government as well as from the legal perspective.

Q. What values do you aim to bring to this partnership?

VM. When it comes to Avientek, we always take the forward call to support our partners. We do it in multiple ways like now, we are extensively investing in demo centres where our partners can do the hands-on testing. Moreover, the partners can bring the end users to have first-hand experience in our test environment. Also, we ensure that every serious partner is having a demo system in their facility to provide the best support to the customers.

Furthermore, we take some of the load off the shoulders of our partners. Like with Mitel, we keep the stock. So, the partner will be able to focus more on their activity like finding new customers, providing the right solution etc. Then obviously, we support the partners on the financial side based on the relationship providing all kinds of credibility.

Q. Are there any specificities in these countries in terms of business needs? What does the market look like here?

AK. Mitel is looking at markets in various continents and countries based on multiple parameters—the first being the potential of the country. It is measured in terms of the addressable market. India definitely has a major TAM, the total addressable market in communication or the business that we are in. Secondly, we look at the political environment, and we found that India is quite stable in that perspective. The third is the financial situation, especially inflation and the Forex. A lot of countries are facing high inflation. I think that is not a problem with India.

Apart from these three things, we also realize that certain international operators, especially in the hospitality domain, are making investments in India and Mitel is very strong in hospitality. So, we found that India is the right fit for us with a high potential.

Q. To what extent do you believe Mitel solutions and Avientek answer the needs of organizations in India?

AK. As one of the global leaders in business communications with 50 years of experience in more than 100 countries, we're quite convinced that we're able to meet the needs of organisations based in India with our solutions. And partnering with Avientek will allow us to have the local footprint and the support needed by partners to best serve their customers.